TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Tell How a Problem at Work Was Solved

Narrate | PPF | Timeline Reconstruction

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell how a problem at work was solved (what went wrong, what you did, how it ended, what you learned) and answer one concern about it.

WHO You and Kumar work in sales at a small company in Johor Bahru that sells printed gifts for other companies: calendars, bags and T-shirts.

SITUATION Two months ago, you sent 500 calendars to a hardware shop in Senai. That afternoon, the owner called, very angry: his logo was green, not blue. Your printer, Ace Print, used the wrong colour.

NEED At Monday's meeting, Mr. Tan asks you to tell the team how you solved it, so new staff know what to do if it happens again. After the story, he will ask one question.

GOAL Tell it in order: what went wrong → what you did and how it ended → what you'll do next time → the lesson. Then answer Mr. Tan's question.

What went wrong

- Two months ago: 500 calendars to a hardware shop in Senai
- That afternoon: the owner called, very angry
- The logo was green, not blue (Ace Print used the wrong colour)

What we did · the result

- Said sorry, drove to Senai to see the calendars
- Called Ace Print: they printed all 500 again, free
- Three days later: new calendars · still our customer

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: “Can you tell the new staff about the calendar problem in Senai? What happened, and how did you fix it?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Kumar’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Two months ago, we sent 500 calendars to a hardware shop in Senai. That afternoon, while I was having lunch, the owner called, very angry: his logo was green, not blue. First, I said sorry and drove there to see them. Then I called Ace Print, and they printed all 500 again, free. Three days later he had them, and he’s still our customer. Next time, before Ace Print prints everything, I’m going to ask for a photo of the first calendar and send it to the customer. What I learned that day: checking one calendar takes two minutes, but printing 500 again takes three days.

P PAST · WHAT WENT WRONG

P PAST → NOW · WHAT WE DID, HOW IT ENDED

F FUTURE · NEXT TIME

! THE LESSON

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti tells how she saved the annual dinner. What went wrong → what we did → next time → the lesson.

- [ ] Next year, I'm going to book a second place early, just in case.
- [ ] First, I called three other places. Then Mr. Tan agreed to a hotel hall for RM500 more, and the night went well.
- [ ] What I learned that week: always have a plan B, even for a dinner.
- [ ] Last December, two days before our annual dinner, the restaurant called: after a small fire, their kitchen was closed.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · what went wrong · **P** = Past → now · what we did, how it ended · **F** = Future · next time · **!** = The lesson

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

WHAT WENT WRONG

- [ ] It happened … ago, at …
- [ ] While I was …, …
- [ ] The problem was that …
- [ ] The customer was angry because …

WHAT WE DID

- [ ] First, I …
- [ ] Then I called … and …
- [ ] After that, we …

HOW IT ENDED

- [ ] In the end, …
- [ ] … days later, …
- [ ] Now the customer is still …

NEXT TIME · THE LESSON

- [ ] Next time, I'm going to …
- [ ] What I learned was that …
- [ ] Now we always …

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] You're right. That's why …
- [ ] That's a fair point. Next time, I'll …
- [ ] I understand. At the time, I …, but …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I was having lunch. [For example, / While … / so] The owner called me.

2. I said sorry. [but / because / First … then …] I drove to Senai to see the calendars.

3. The owner was very angry. [then / because / so] His logo was green, not blue.

4. Ace Print printed all 500 again. [In the end, / For example, / If …] The shop had its new calendars three days later.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I _____ lunch when the owner called. (The background: what was happening)
   ○ having ○ was having ○ was have
2. That afternoon, the owner _____ me, very angry. (What happened: a finished event)
   ○ calling ○ called ○ call
3. Three days later, we _____ the new calendars to Senai. (What we did: an irregular past)
   ○ sent ○ sending ○ sended
4. Next time, I _____ ask for a photo of the first one. (Next time: a plan)
   ○ am go to ○ am going to ○ going to

SLIDE 09

While I was … (the background)

In a story, use was / were + -ing for what was already happening, and the past simple for the event that came in the middle of it. Then first, then, in the end give the order.

While I was having lunch, the owner **called**.

We **were closing** the shop when the lights **went** out.

First, I **said** sorry. **Then** I **called** Ace Print.

In the end, he **had** his calendars three days later.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · WHAT WENT WRONG

… ago, we … at … While I was …, …

P

PAST → NOW · WHAT WE DID, HOW IT ENDED

First, I … Then … In the end, …

F

FUTURE · NEXT TIME

Next time, I'm going to …

!

THE LESSON

What I learned was that …

SLIDE 11

Timeline Reconstruction

The speaker tells how a problem was solved from a mixed-up card. The listener was not there: they write the timeline as they hear it and read it back, then raise one concern, and the speaker answers it.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number. Speaker: tell it in order: went wrong → what you did → the end → the lesson.
2. Listener: write what you hear, in that order, and read it back. Then one concern. Speaker: acknowledge and answer it.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same story to a new listener, shorter. New column, new concern.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: workbook turned over, story only; listener writes key words. Then swap roles.

Card 1 · A phone repair shop

Card 2 · A restaurant

Card 3 · An office

Card 4 · A condo

Listener's timeline

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
What went wrong			
What they did, in order			
How it ended			
Lesson / next time			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Why didn't anyone check the calendars before we sent them?**
2. **The owner was very angry. Why didn't you tell me that day?**
3. **A photo on a phone can look different. Is that really enough?**

Start with: **You're right. That's why next time … · I understand. At the time, I …, but … · That's a fair point. So I'll also …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Outside work: tell a friend about a problem you solved at home or on a trip. For example, your car broke down on the way to a family wedding in Melaka, or a water pipe burst at home during Chinese New Year. What went wrong, what you did, how it ended, what you learned.

Last year, while we were … · First, I … Then … · In the end, … · What I learned was that …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says when and where, then tells what went wrong and what was done, in an order the listener can write down.
- [ ] Says how it ended and names one lesson or one thing to do next time.
- [ ] Acknowledges the listener's concern and answers it in one or two sentences.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

The scene and the order of events	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
How it ended and the lesson	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A phone repair shop

You own the phone shop. You were away that day. Write it as you hear it; ask 'When?' if you need to. Then raise one concern: 'Why didn't you …?' or 'Was … enough?'

Card 2 · A restaurant

You manage the restaurant. You were on leave that night. Write it as you hear it; ask 'When?' if you need to. Then raise one concern: 'Why didn't you …?' or 'Was … enough?'

Card 3 · An office

You are Mr. Tan. You were in KL that week. Write it as you hear it; ask 'When?' if you need to. Then raise one concern: 'Why didn't you …?' or 'Was … enough?'

Card 4 · A condo

You are the condo manager, just back from holiday. Write it as you hear it; ask 'When?' if you need to. Then raise one concern: 'Why didn't you …?' or 'Was … enough?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A phone repair shop

Then: new screen, free, 40 min · Last Saturday, 11 a.m., 8 people waiting · A man came back shouting: the screen we fixed on Thursday was dead · End: he left happy · First: took him to a quiet corner · Lesson: test every screen

Card 2 · A restaurant

First: said sorry to the angry father · Friday, 8 p.m.: a family of 12, for a birthday · Next time: all bookings in one book · Problem: we gave their table away · Then: 2 tables upstairs, 15 min, free dessert · End: they stayed

Card 3 · An office

End: all 15 paid by 4 p.m. · The 28th, 10 a.m.: the bank rejected our salary payment · Then: fixed 2 wrong account numbers · 15 staff not paid; 2 angry at my desk · Lesson: check numbers when people join · First: called the bank

Card 4 · A condo

Then: carried an old lady's shopping to floor 15 · Sunday, 9 a.m.: the Block B lift stopped · Lesson: post an update every hour · First: called the lift company · Angry messages in the residents' group · End: fixed by 6 p.m.